

February 3, 2026

Kimberly D. Bose, Secretary
Federal Energy Regulatory Commission
888 First Street, NE
Washington, DC 20426

**Re: Comments of Brian Handshy in Docket No. RM26-4-000
Large Generator Interconnection Agreements and Procedures**

Dear Secretary Bose:

Pursuant to the Notice of Proposed Rulemaking issued by the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission in the above-referenced docket, Brian Handshy, Principal Consultant at Front Door Technologies LLC, respectfully submits the enclosed comments addressing proposals to use Virtual Power Plant resources and residential Demand Response for data center interconnection offsets.

This comment demonstrates through rigorous quantitative analysis that applying regional Resource Adequacy metrics (specifically Effective Load Carrying Capability values) to local interconnection engineering creates systematic reliability risks due to fundamental differences between these two grid reliability mechanisms. Using Monte Carlo simulation with empirically grounded probability distributions, the analysis reveals that Virtual Power Plant portfolios provide less than 5% of their regional capacity credit value for local interconnection purposes—representing order-of-magnitude overestimation if regional metrics are applied directly to interconnection studies.

The comment concludes that while Virtual Power Plants provide valuable contributions to regional Resource Adequacy and should continue to receive appropriate compensation through capacity markets, their statistical performance across multi-state footprints cannot substitute for the deterministic, worst-case physical analysis required by the Commission's interconnection study standards under Order No. 2003 and Order No. 2023.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you require any additional information or clarification regarding these comments.

Respectfully submitted,

Brian Handshy
Principal Consultant
Front Door Technologies LLC
Lawrence, Kansas
Phone: (785) 304-5454
Email: brian.handshy@frontdoortech.co